

English Reading Comprehension

LECTURE - 2

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

Read the passage given below:

- **1.** I know many friends of mine who drink coffee regularly but do not know that coffee exists in different forms other than instant coffee. There are many who swear by Flora café classic or Coco gold, which they consider premium coffee. I may sound offensive but instant coffee is not the only way; in fact it's a very bad way of making coffee! Instant coffee cannot match up to brewed coffee's flavour nor does it have Arabica beans. It uses Robusta beans that are lower in flavour. Don't know the difference?! Read on ...

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- **2.** That plant might be a genius! It created a chemical that would keep pests away. Fortunately for us and unfortunately for the plant - that plan did not work the way it was intended to. The chemical might have averted a few pest attacks, but attracted a far greater threat human beings. The plant I am talking about is coffee and the chemical is caffeine.
- **3.** To begin from the beginning - coffee is from a more mature part of the tree - the seed - unlike other stimulants. The ripe berry is picked and de-pulped leaving us with a seed called 'green bean' or 'green coffee'. Green bean is uncharacteristically bland with a taste nowhere close to that of coffee, but it is valued for its higher antioxidant levels.

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- 4. It's an interesting phenomenon to see how this bland green bean turns to a flavourful coffee bean. Coffee bean is a seed and like any other seed is rich in proteins, fats and all necessary ingredients for giving birth to a new plant. When exposed to heat, the fats and carbohydrates in the bean turn into essential oils, which give the characteristic taste and aroma to the coffee bean. The degree of roasting depends on the need or purpose of use.

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- **5.** These beans are ground so that the surface area of the bean is increased, which makes extraction easier. The bean can be ground or crushed but making the particles uniform will ensure equal extraction, or else the smaller particle will get over extracted and the larger one under extracted. Hence, the burr grinder is used to ensure that the coffee bean gets ground in a uniform way in which all particles are of similar sizes.
- **6.** Does under extraction give a lighter coffee and over extraction a stronger one? No. For a lighter or stronger coffee less or more coffee powder has to be used. Why? Under extraction will not get all the flavours of the coffee as the water runs too quickly. It will not get what you want - it will taste sour. Overextraction will bring out all unnecessary flavours rendering the taste bitter.

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

1. Complete the sentence by choosing an appropriate option.

The author complained that his friends _____.

- (a) were severely addicted to drinking coffee.
- (b) consumed only Flora classics.
- (c) were not aware of different forms of coffee. ✓
- (d) considered Coco gold as premium coffee.

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Ans. (c) were not aware of different forms of coffee.

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

2. Comment on the writer's reference to the unique feature of coffee plant. (paragraph 2)

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Ans. The writer's reference to the coffee plant is simultaneously hilarious and sarcastic. By referring to plants as organisms with thought and showing coffee-drinkers as "pests", the author has successfully gained a few laughs from the audience.

→ Unique Features:-

- Produces a chemical — To keep pests away
- Human beings act as those pests → consume 
 - consume
 - Coff
 - Coffee

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3. List the reason why the author refers to humans as great threat to coffee plants.

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Ans. The author refers humans as a great threat to coffee plants because the chemical that the plants had originally produced to ward off pests, is the same chemical that humans call coffee and chug happily. So, in the end, the real "threat" to the plants came not from the pests, but from humans, who mass-manufactured plants for coffee.

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

4. Select an option that conveys the same meaning as energiser from words used in paragraph 3.

- (a) antioxidant
- (b) stimulants
- (c) bland
- (d) mature

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Ans. (b) stimulants ✓

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

5. Complete the given sentence with an appropriate inference with respect to the following:

Fats and carbohydrates turn into essential oils leading to _____.

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Ans. the characteristic taste and aroma of the coffee bean



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6. Comment on the writer's reference to the interesting phenomenon in paragraph 4.

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Ans. The writer does an excellent job of describing the interesting phenomenon of the green bean turning into a flavorful coffee bean. They explain that when the bean is exposed to heat, the fats and carbohydrates turn into essential oils, which give the characteristic flavor and aroma to the coffee bean. They also touch on the importance of uniform grinding so that all particles are of similar sizes in order to ensure equal extraction. This is a great explanation and well-referenced to the process of making coffee.

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7. Over extraction does not give a stronger coffee. Based on your understanding of paragraph 6, list one method to get stronger coffee.

Rayada Powder.

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Ans. One method to get stronger coffee is to use more coffee powder. This will ensure that the water has enough time to extract all the flavours from the coffee beans, giving you a stronger cup of coffee.

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8. The writer would not agree with the given statements based on paragraph five **EXCEPT**

- (a) The burr grinder grinds coffee beans uniformly.
- (b) Grinding gives stronger aroma.
- (c) Good coffee is a mix of smaller and bigger particles.
- (d) ~~Less surface area makes extraction easier.~~
→ increased.

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Ans. (d) Less surface area makes extraction easier.

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9. Why is it fair to say that the right degree of extraction of coffee is important?

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Ans. The right degree of extraction of coffee is important because it will determine the flavor, aroma and overall taste of the coffee. If the extraction is done incorrectly, the coffee will either taste sour and under-extracted or bitter and over-extracted. The right degree of extraction requires precise control over the amount of coffee and the time it is exposed to water. Only then can you create the perfectly balanced cup of coffee.

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10. Select the most suitable title of the above passage.

~~(a)~~ The Coffee Addict ✓

(b) The Art of Coffee Making

~~(c)~~ Benefits of Consuming Coffee X

~~(d)~~ Green Coffee – The perfect antioxidant X

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Ans. (b) The Art of Coffee Making



H/W

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

- **1.** My father has always been a passionate man. He has always been passionate about the people of the Everest region - so much so that in 1960 he began the first of the many projects aimed at improving their lives. In 1975 he had begun building his second hospital in the Himalayas when tragedy struck our family. My mother and my youngest sister Belinda were flying into the mountains to join him when their small aeroplane crashed soon after take-off from Kathmandu.

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- **2.** I was in Assam when I first heard of the accident. I flew straight to Kathmandu and met my father and oldest sister Sarah on a narrow lane on the outskirts of the city. Any hope I had clung to, that my mother and sister were still alive, was extinguished the moment I saw father - bowed and broken. I knew then that Mum and Belinda would never return.

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

- **3.** It was years before Dad fully came out of this period of darkness. Only by plunging himself into more adventures and ever more projects in Nepal, could he get through it. He has built 42 schools and hospitals there.
- **4.** As I grew up, some of Dad's restlessness rubbed off on me. I know many people think there must be some compulsion for the son of Sir Edmund Hillary to climb mountains. They assume that there was some imperative etched in stone that says, "Thou shalt climb mountains" - and in particular Everest, whether you like it or not. But for me, it's simpler than that. I think families are like factories: the Hillary family is a limited production mountaineering establishment.

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- **5.** Today, at the age of 48, I am an inveterate mountain man. I have been on more than 30 mountaineering expeditions, from the Himalayas to the Antarctic. And yes, I have climbed Everest - twice.
- **6.** I treasure the same things that drew my father to climbing - the tremendous camaraderie involved, the intensity and adrenaline buzz especially in dangerous places where your life depends upon making the right call. I guess that I am luckier than most because I am able to fall back on all that my father has taught me.

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

1. Complete the sentence by choosing an appropriate option.
The author's father was passionate about the people of the Everest region; so he _____.
- (a) Climbed mountains
 - (b) Worked on the improvement of their lives
 - (c) Built schools and hospitals everywhere
 - (d) Invited all the family to stay there

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

Ans. (b) Worked on the improvement of their lives

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

- 2. Comment on the effect of the plane crash in 1975 on the life Hillary family.**

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

Ans. The plane crash in 1975 led to the turning point in the author and his father's life. Author's mother and my youngest sister Belinda were flying on that plane to join his father in the Himalayas.

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

- 3. List the two ways how author's father came out of the dark phase in his life
(Clue: Think about the type his engagements)**

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

Ans. The author's father came out of the dark phase in his life by engaging himself in social service.

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

4. Select the option that conveys the opposite of 'lethargy', from words used in paragraph six.

- (a)** treasure
- (b)** camaraderie
- (c)** intensity
- (d)** adrenaline

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Ans. (c) intensity

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

- 5.** How did the author prove to be the true son of his father?
- (a)** He proved to be an excellent mountaineer
 - (b)** He involved himself in social service
 - (c)** He scaled the Everest twice
 - (d)** All of these

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

Ans. (a) He proved to be an excellent mountaineer

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- 6.** Based on your understanding of the last paragraph, list one major advantage that the author had which made him consider himself fortunate.

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Ans. The author considered himself to be lucky because he could learn from his father's experiences.

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7. Why did the author take up climbing like his father?

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Ans. Because he was born in a family of mountaineers.

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

- 8.** Complete the given sentence with an appropriate inference, with respect to the following:
The phrase "Thou shalt climb mountains" means _____.

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Ans. You shall climb mountains

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

9. A word similar in meaning to "section" in paragraph two is
- (a) narrow
 - (b) outskirts
 - (c) extinguished
 - (d) broken

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Ans. (b) outskirts

READ THE TEXT CAREFULLY AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

- 10.** Select the most suitable title for the above passage.
- (a)** Mountaineering and Hillary family
 - (b)** Tragedy that Struck the Hillary family
 - (c)** Mountaineering - a passion of Hillary family
 - (d)** Plane Crash and Mountaineering

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Ans. (a) Mountaineering and Hillary family

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